

Conflict-Related Sexual Violence in Security Council Resolutions

Verification of the 2000–2025 dataset against source documents, and what the rebuilt data now shows

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Subject	Dataset v2026.09 — corrections requiring your decision, and six findings

Summary

Every one of the 72 resolutions in the database has now been checked against its source document, paragraph by paragraph. The coding was also extended: where the inherited dataset recorded a few representative paragraphs per resolution, the new version records every paragraph that carries relevant language. The database has gone from 169 paragraph references to 409 rows, and each row now carries its source file, its verbatim text, its obligating verb, a tier, and — where applicable — the earlier paragraph it was carried forward from.

The verification found errors that need your decision before anything is published: four records with the wrong country or date, twelve paragraph references pointing at the wrong paragraph, one quotation that appears nowhere in its resolution, five records with no codable content at all, and three quotations that do not reproduce the Council’s verb.

Some of these entries originate in my own earlier coding pass, and I should have caught them then. The account below is of the dataset as it stood, including the parts of it that were mine.

The rebuilt data also supports findings the earlier structure could not express. The most consequential is that the three largest situation tracks move in different directions: language on the DRC grows in volume while weakening in force, South Sudan grows in both, and the West African and Somali missions never once used a mandatory verb on sexual violence across their whole lifespans.

I. Corrections carried out against the source text

These are matters of fact, verified against the UN documents. They are recorded in the dataset with the original values preserved, so every change is traceable.

Metadata

Resolution	Recorded	Document
S/RES/2753 (2024)	Haiti, adopted 30 September 2024	Somalia, adopted 30 October 2024, 9764th meeting
S/RES/2060 (2012)	Myanmar, mission mandate	Somalia and Eritrea sanctions renewal; no CRSV language
S/RES/2734 (2024)	Adopted 20 June 2024	Adopted 10 June 2024, 9649th meeting
S/RES/2745 (2024)	Adopted 31 July 2024	Adopted 30 July 2024, 9695th meeting

The 2060 correction removes Myanmar from the dataset altogether: it was the only Myanmar record, and the document is not about Myanmar.

Paragraph references

Twelve of the 169 inherited references point at a different paragraph from the one quoted. The pattern is concentrated in the thematic and sanctions resolutions; the mission mandates are largely accurate.

Resolution	Recorded	Actual	Note
S/RES/1888	¶8, ¶12	¶12, ¶8	the two are transposed
S/RES/1960	¶3, ¶7	¶8, ¶5	neither number is right
S/RES/2106	¶5	¶4	verb also altered
S/RES/2242	¶13, ¶14	¶1, ¶13	both quote participation language, not CRSV
S/RES/2467	¶5, ¶18, ¶27	¶15, ¶16, ¶18	all three wrong; one verb altered
S/RES/2745	¶21(b), ¶21(c)	¶5	2745 has 13 paragraphs; ¶21 belongs to 2399 (2018)

Altered verbs

Three quotations do not reproduce the Council’s verb. Given that the project’s analytical interest is the strength of obligation, these are worth setting out individually.

Resolution	Quoted as	Document reads
S/RES/1888 ¶8	Requests the Secretary-General to establish a team of experts	Calls upon the Secretary-General to identify and take the appropriate measures to deploy rapidly a team of experts
S/RES/2106 ¶4	Emphasizes the importance of a comprehensive approach	Draws attention to the importance of a comprehensive approach
S/RES/2467 ¶16	Calls upon Member States to adopt a survivor-centered approach	Encourages Member States to adopt a survivor-centered approach

All three substitutions happen to run in the same direction, towards a stronger obligation. Three instances is not a pattern in any statistical sense, and I would not draw an inference from it. But the 2467 case touches the survivor-centred provision that was the hardest-fought element of that negotiation, and I would rather we record the point in the method note ourselves than leave it to be found later.

Records with nothing to code

Five resolutions contain no sexual-violence, gender-based-violence or children language anywhere in their text: S/RES/2118 (Syria, 2013), S/RES/2768 (Yemen, 2025), S/RES/2107 (Iraq, 2013), S/RES/1836 (Liberia, 2008) and S/RES/2060 (2012). They remain in the dataset as flagged empty records pending your decision on scope.

One further quotation, attributed to S/RES/2331 ¶4 (“Urges Member States to address the factors that make people vulnerable to trafficking in persons...”), appears in no operative paragraph of that resolution. The word “vulnerable” occurs only in its preamble. The entry has been struck and replaced with the paragraphs the resolution actually contains.

II. What the rebuilt data shows

1. The three largest tracks move in opposite directions

Coding every paragraph, and recording the verb that carries it, separates volume from force. On the DRC track the volume rises and the force falls: the 2020 mandate carries thirteen coded paragraphs, of which eight are hortatory and only one is a mandated task, and the Women Protection Adviser provision has moved from “decides to include” in 2010 to “acknowledges the important role of” in 2020. On South Sudan both rise: the 2021 mandate demands that parties prevent further commission of sexual violence, and the 2024 mandate condemns and demands. On the Côte d'Ivoire, Liberia and Somalia tracks, no resolution in the whole series uses a mandatory verb on sexual violence at any point.

This is awkward for any account in which a norm diffuses from the thematic resolutions outward. It points instead to the strength of language being set by the politics of each situation and the standing of each mission.

2. “Practice first, text second” holds only where practice already existed

Operative CRSV language appears on the DRC track in 2007 and in the Darfur preamble in 2005, both before resolution 1820 (2008); the Sudan sanctions criterion of 2005 likewise precedes it. But Côte d'Ivoire waited until 2010, Liberia until 2013, and the Libya mandate track has no operative sexual-violence provision to this day. The thematic text codified existing practice; it did not by itself create practice where there was none.

3. Which instrument carries the language is itself a variable

Libya is the clearest case: the sanctions regime has a designation criterion naming sexual and gender-based violence, while the UNSMIL mandate has nothing operative on the subject. Yemen places its criterion inside country-specific resolutions rather than a sanctions text. The Central African Republic inherits its criterion by cross-reference to an earlier resolution. The inherited dataset flattened these three instrument types into one table and so could not pose the question.

4. The designation chain now runs end to end — and ends twice

The line is complete in the data: 1820 ¶5 states an intention; 1888 ¶10, 1960 ¶7, 2106 ¶13, 2242 ¶6, 2331 ¶12 and 2467 ¶¶10–12 develop it; nine sanctions regimes carry it into criteria; and 2653 ¶25 turns the incidence of sexual violence into a benchmark for lifting measures.

Two paragraphs at the end of that chain were absent from the dataset and are the most significant additions in this revision. The annex to S/RES/2564 (2021) designates Sultan Saleh Aida Aida Zabin on the basis of “a policy of intimidation and use of systematic arrest, detention, torture, sexual violence and rape against politically active women”. The annex to S/RES/2624 (2022) designates the Houthis for “a policy of sexual violence and repression against politically active and professional women”. Fourteen years of architecture, and two applications recorded in this corpus.

5. Renewal language can now be measured, not assumed

Sixty-three paragraphs match an earlier paragraph on the same track. Five are effectively verbatim. The Mali renewal is the clearest: nine paragraphs of S/RES/2640 (2022) match S/RES/2584 (2021), several above 0.93 similarity and one at 0.97. Counted by resolution, Mali contributes twelve coded paragraphs in each of those years; counted by text, the 2022 resolution adds almost nothing. Any annual series built on paragraph counts measures renewal cadence unless this is discounted.

A second pattern emerged once the comparison was widened to all earlier resolutions on a track: resolution 2467 (2019) reaches back past 2106 (2013) to 1888 and 1960 for three of its paragraphs, with almost no resemblance to the intervening text. In drafting terms 2467 continues 1960 rather than 2106 — a proposition that could be checked against the 2019 negotiation record.

6. The three-way typology of designation criteria does not survive the text

Coding the textual form of each criterion rather than applying a label yields six forms: enumerated (a criterion of its own), embedded (named inside a broader criterion), extension (appended by “such acts may also include”), eligibility (declaring that sexual violence falls within criteria set elsewhere), generic (no mention, covered by humanitarian-law language), and by reference. On that basis 2441 (Libya) and 2444 (Al-Shabaab) are extensions rather than standalone criteria, and 2734 (1267) is an eligibility statement identical in form to 2511 (Yemen), which the dataset correctly labels pseudo-standalone.

The practical consequence: the number of regimes with a standalone sexual-violence designation criterion falls from five to two, or three if the Central African Republic is counted through its cross-reference. Both the inherited label and the derived form are kept side by side in the data, with a conflict flag, so nothing changes

until you decide.

III. Questions for your decision

- **Scope.** Resolution 1325 (2000) is absent while 2242 (2015) is present, and 2242 is overwhelmingly an architecture text: twelve of its eighteen paragraphs carry no violence component. Is the inclusion rule “resolutions carrying specific CRSV language”, or “the WPS architecture plus CRSV”? The present set implies the first, inconsistently.
- **Empty records.** Keep the five resolutions with no codable content as flagged entries, or remove them?
- **Renewals.** Where a renewal reproduces the previous year's paragraph, is it a new data point or a continuation? This decides whether the annual series measures Council attention or drafting cadence.
- **Designation typology.** Adopt the derived six-form coding, keep the inherited three-way labels, or publish both? If any figure on standalone criteria has been used externally, it will need correcting.
- **Preambular language.** The definitional clause of the whole agenda — that women and girls are targeted by sexual violence as a tactic of war — is preambular in 1820, and all of 2367's content is preambular. Preambular clauses are unnumbered in the documents, so any reference to them is verifiable by text but not by number. Do we code them as a separate layer?
- **Categories.** Four resolutions recorded as mission mandates (2035, 2060, 2340, 2633) contain no mandate language at all and are sanctions or Panel of Experts renewals. Reassign, or leave flagged?
- **Attribution and licence.** The visualisation and dataset carry your name as project lead and hold your copyright. No licence has been set. CC BY 4.0 for the data and coding scheme with MIT for the code would be the usual pairing, but the decision is yours.

IV. Method and limits

Sources were the 72 UN documents themselves — 56 as extracted text, 16 as PDFs. Each recorded reference was located in its document by matching bigram overlap between the quoted text and every paragraph, then confirmed by reading. Machine screening produced false positives, which is why every flagged case was adjudicated by hand before being recorded. The finished table passed a nine-point validation: field consistency against the source register, controlled vocabularies, duplicate keys, paragraph numbers within document range, verbatim presence of every quotation in its source, opening verb, and the internal consistency of the carry-forward columns.

Limits worth stating in any publication:

- The 72 resolutions are an inherited selection, not a population. Every trend is conditional on that selection.
- Tier assignments (CRSV, sexual exploitation and abuse, children and armed conflict, trafficking, gender language without violence) are mine. Another coder would move some boundaries; the coding rules are documented so that this can be tested.
- Carry-forward similarity is computed only within these 72 documents. Many intervening renewals are not in the corpus, so the Mali figure of 0.92 is a floor, not a ceiling.
- Preambular language is coded only where the inherited dataset already referenced it.

Attached: **crsv-paragraphs-v2026.09.csv** (409 rows, 33 columns — the working dataset, with every inherited reference accounted for and every change traceable); **paragraph-audit.csv** (the 169 inherited references with claimed reference, located reference, match score and adjudication). The interactive visualisation has been rebuilt on the corrected links and attribution and can be shared once you have settled the questions in section III.